

2, Gratitude to My Pet Turtledove, "Choubao" (Stinky Baby)

The final two chapters differ fundamentally from all the preceding ones. Although the contents of Chapters 1 through 11 were discovered by me much earlier (*with some sections repositioned forward during the editing process out of logical necessity*), they were gradually compiled and written down only in 2024. However, from this point forward until the conclusion, everything was drafted simultaneously with the original manuscript prior to any major editing.

When I decided to begin documenting this record, I had already completely abandoned the thought of pursuing a Ph.D., because my parents did not support it. In reality, this is the tragedy of a typical Chinese family. Parents do not believe their children possess independent personalities or the capacity to observe the world and draw their own conclusions. My mother would rather believe a random outsider of unknown origins, or those utterly incomprehensible short videos on her smartphone, than trust me even once. She takes immense pleasure in adopting the stance of outsiders to insult and humiliate me.

This is incredibly normalized in our nation's society. Because every member endures tremendous oppression from the society at large, they are conditioned to displace this oppression onto those they *can* oppress, deriving a sick sense of satisfaction from doing so.

Even though the directives issued within the household often contradict themselves within a 24-hour window, I am acutely aware that they see absolutely no value in pursuing a Ph.D., nor do they consider conducting academic research a respectable or meaningful profession. I cannot blame them for this. My parents, like the rest of the Chinese populace, are tragic figures. Their observation of reality is, in fact, flawless: in our society, scientific research was never a respected profession to begin with! **In this society, what commands respect first and foremost is power, followed closely by money.**

I felt profoundly helpless. If my academic excellence was sufficient to secure scholarships all the way through, it wouldn't have been entirely impossible to defy the pressure from my family and continue my studies. But evidently, I lacked that extraordinary capacity, and thus, I could only give up.

During these unfortunate and miserable years, my grandparents' pet turtledove, "Choubao" (臭宝 / Stinky Baby), provided me with immense psychological comfort.

Choubao is an Oriental Turtle Dove (山斑鸠) I rescued at the driving test center on August 2, 2022, while I was taking my driving test. He was only about ten days old at the time and had fallen out of his nest prematurely. After I picked Choubao up, he was raised as a pet in my grandparents' home as a fledgling unable to fly. We later discovered he is a male.

Although the Oriental Turtle Dove is one of the more difficult dove species to domesticate, because Choubao was raised in a human household from such a tender age, he is now completely domesticated. When people ignore him, Choubao will actively run up to us and coo. Or, when I am sleeping, he will secretly hop onto my pillow, rub his tiny head against my ear, and emit soft cooing sounds. Whenever he is petted, he twitches his wings in absolute delight.

Previously, my family had never kept a pet capable of human interaction. It wasn't until we had Choubao that I realized keeping a pet is an incredibly profoundly meaningful endeavor. Beyond providing companionship for adults, pets are especially meaningful for children.

First, **pets can teach children how to love.** Even a seven- or eight-year-old child just starting elementary school is already intellectually and physically superior to the vast majority of common pets. Unlike facing adults like their parents—where children often feel inadequate and are mostly on the receiving end of affection, finding it difficult to actively express care—young children can proactively care for their pets. This is immensely beneficial for the formation of a well-rounded, wholesome personality.

Second, **pets can teach children responsibility.** At a young age, the responsibilities children can bear are extremely limited, and the law does not consider individuals below a certain age capable of assuming behavioral responsibility. However, through interacting with pets, children can recognize what it actually feels like to shoulder responsibility, understand its significance, and reap a sense of fulfillment. This is astronomically beneficial for molding qualified citizens.

Third, **pets can teach children the concept of death.** The vast majority of pets possess short lifespans; a turtledove like Choubao can live for about ten years at most. Under current medical conditions, many elders from the grandparent generation, with whom my generation shares intimate relationships, are still alive and well by the time we reach adulthood; whereas the great-grandparent generation is often too old, resulting in emotional detachment. A pet is a companion into whom a child pours a massive amount of emotion. Even though the pet is destined to leave its little master, it can still teach them the final, most crucial lesson of life: how to perceive death. As the single most important subject in human philosophy, I believe no wise person should avoid contemplating it.

However, it is a profound pity that current Chinese families, especially urban ones, severely lack the conditions to allow children to raise pets. Whether constrained by ideology or economic limitations, raising pets is often condemned as a frivolous distraction that saps one's ambition (玩物丧志).

More importantly: **Chinese people do not know how to love, therefore they are deceitful and cruel to their compatriots! They do not understand responsibility, therefore they allow public power to run rampant and unchecked! They are apathetic toward death, therefore they do not know how a human being ought to spend their life!**

This systemic tragedy renders the act of children raising pets entirely meaningless in this environment.

Regardless of everything, Choubao is undeniably a radiant, dazzling spark of light in my life. I regard him as a miraculous gift bestowed upon me by God.

2, 感谢我的宠物斑鸠“臭宝”

最后两个章节不同于之前的各个章节，第一到第十一章的内容虽然在更早的时候就被我发现（部分内容是在整理的过程中因为逻辑需要被调整到前方），却是在 2024 年才被逐渐整理的。但是从这个位置开始到结尾的内容，都属于我在整理之前的文稿同时所完成的。在我决定开始写下这份记录的时候，我已经完全放弃了读博的考虑，因为我父母并不支持这一点。实际上，这就是一个典型的中国式家庭的悲剧，家长们并不会认为自己的子女具有独立人格和观察世界并得到结论的能力。我的妈妈宁可相信任何不知道从什么时候认识的外人，或者是手机上的那些完全难以理解的短视频，也不愿意相信我任何一次，她非常喜欢站在外人的立场上侮辱我。这在我国的社会是非常正常的，因为每一个成员都要承受来自社会极大的压迫，他们习惯于将这种压迫转移给他们能压迫的人，并且以此获得满足感。尽管家里的指令常常在 24 小时内前后矛盾，但我很清楚他们并不认为读博有什么意义，更不认为进行学术研究是一样受尊重且有意义的工作。这无法怪他们，我的父母跟中国的其他人民一样可悲，他们的观察是没错的，因为在我国社会，科学研究本来也不是一个受尊重的工作。在我们这个社会首先受到尊重的是权力，其次则是金钱。

我感到非常无奈，如果我学得足够好，能够一路拿奖学金的话，也不是不能顶着家里的压力学下去，但显然我没有这个能力，也就只能放弃了。在这些不幸的岁月里，姥爷姥姥的宠物斑鸠“臭宝”给了我非常大的心理慰藉。臭宝是我在2022年8月2日参加驾考科目二考试的时候在考场捡到的一只山斑鸠，它当时只有大概十天大，过早地从窝里掉了下来。我把臭宝捡到之后它就作为一只还不会飞的幼鸟被养在姥爷姥姥家当宠物了，后来我们发现它是一只公鸟。虽然山斑鸠在常见斑鸠里面属于难以驯化的一类，但是因为臭宝从小在家里养大，现在已经完全宠物化了。臭宝会在人们忽视它的时候主动跑到面前咕咕叫，或者在我睡觉的时候偷偷跳到枕头上用小脑袋蹭我的耳朵，然后发出咕咕声，它被抚摸的时候会非常高兴的抖翅膀。在以前我们家里并没有能与人互动的宠物，直到有了臭宝之后我意识到养宠物是一件非常有意义的事情，除了对成年人的陪伴以外，宠物对于孩子尤其有意义。第一，宠物能够教会孩子们去爱。因为即使是七八岁刚刚上小学的儿童，在智力和体力上已经强于绝大多数常见宠物。不同于在面对父母这样的成年人的时候显得力不从心，更多是接受关爱而难以去主动地表达关爱，儿童在年纪较小的时候就可以照顾自己的宠物，这有利于一个完善人格的形成。第二，宠物能够教会孩子们责任。在年龄尚小的时候，儿童能承担的责任非常少，法律也不认为在一定年龄之前的人具有承担一些行为责任的能力。但是孩子们可以通过与宠物的互动认识到承担责任的是什么样一种体验，了解其意义并收获满足感，这对于造就合格的公民是非常有益的。第三，宠物能够让孩子们认识什么是死亡。绝大多数宠物的寿命都不长，像臭宝这样的斑鸠大概也就能活十年。在现在的医疗条件下，我这一代人中很多直到成年的时候具有亲密关系的爷爷辈的长辈还都健在，而在上一代人却又太老，在情感上已经很疏离了。宠物是儿童倾注了大量感情的伙伴，即使他注定会离开小主人，也能够教给他们最后一堂重要的人生课程，如何看待死亡。我认为作为人类哲学中最重要的一个课题，明智的人不应该不思考它。但是很可惜的是，现在的中国式家庭特别是城市家庭缺少让孩子养宠物的条件，无论是观念上还是在经济条件上，这会被视为一种玩物丧志的行为。更重要的是，中国人不懂得爱人，所以对同胞狡猾又残忍；不了解责任，所以任由公共权力横行无忌；漠视死亡，所以不知道人应该怎样度过一生。这就更使得孩子们饲养宠物失去了意义。无论如何，臭宝确实是我的生命中璀璨的亮色，我把他视为上帝赐给自己的礼物。